

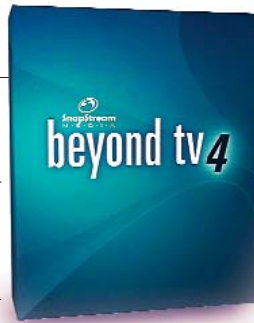
Beyond TV 4.4

The Best Yet!

Beyond TV from Snapstream has been known as one of the best PVR software available, so we decided to see if this claim holds any water.

We have just one word for the interface—beautiful! It's even better than the Windows Media Center PVR interface, which was our favourite until now. Beyond TV makes full use of the 3D hardware acceleration of your video card to apply transparency effects to the video overlay window.

The interface lets you configure various settings to fine-tune channels. It supports video capture in DivX, MPEG-2 as well WMV, and you can use the timeshift feature to pause Live TV and skip certain parts. To make videos portable, Beyond TV has a ShowSqueeze feature that recompresses movies for easy playback on portable devices. Beyond TV also has a media player that can play movies in the mentioned formats. It is capable of tuning



FM radio—if your TV-Tuner supports FM—and capturing audio from it as well.

Beyond TV supports all TV-Tuners (analogue and digital) that support Windows XP MCE, and a few more. It even supports multiple

TV-Tuners, allowing you to view multiple channels at the same time, or view one and record another simultaneously.

The only thing missing is the ability to directly burn captured content to DVD. Still, this is the best PVR software we have tested!

Specifications

Supports analogue and digital telecasts, supports HDTV, records in DivX, MPEG-2 and WMV, supports timeshift, play and pause FM Radio, Firefly PC Remote.

Web site: www.snapstream.com
Price: Rs 3,250 (\$69.99)

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

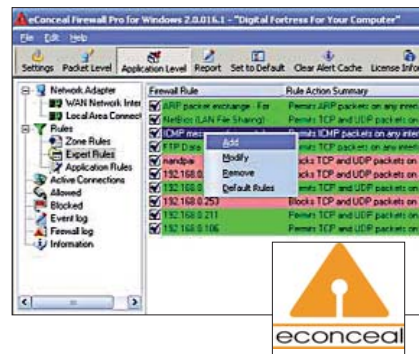
eConceal Pro Firewall

A No-Frills Firewall

eConceal Firewall is a software firewall from MicroWorld, the makers of eScan Antivirus. Whenever an application tries to access the Internet, eConceal prompts you with options as to whether that application is to be permitted to do so. You can create a rule to allow this application to always access the Internet, or block it permanently.

eConceal can be configured for packet-level filtering as well. In addition to the powerful user-defined rules, you can choose from preset rules created for different applications such as e-mail, FTP, chat clients, etc. The software supports port monitoring and alerts you in case of unauthorised intrusion attempts. The attacker's IP is automatically banned, and he can no longer attack using that port. You can surf invisibly—eConceal can be configured to only let in that content from the Web that you request.

Other features include a pop-up blocker, parental



controls to block porn sites (which can also be used by enterprises to block non-business Web sites), a graphical real-time report of network traffic, and password protection. A no-frills firewall that gets the job done!

Specifications

Application and packet-level filtering, user-defined and preset rules, port monitoring, stealth surfing, pop-up blocker, parental controls, real-time traffic

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

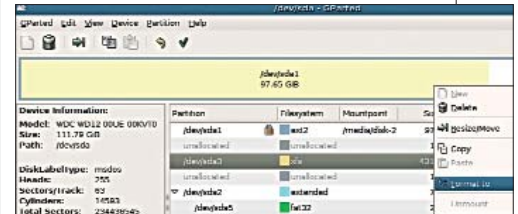
Contact: MicroWorld Software Services Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-28265701
E-mail: sales@mwti.net
Web site: www.mwti.net
Price: Rs 1,600 (approx)

GParted

Clean, Quick Partitioning

Finally, a partition manager just the way it should be. GParted (GNOME Partition Editor) is a freeware partition manager based on Linux, but it's not limited to that OS. *Get it Free from our this month's DVD.*

GParted is available in three forms: a binary that can be compiled on any



Linux distro, a LiveCD which can be burnt onto CD, and a LiveUSB distribution that can be run by booting off a USB drive. We booted off the LiveCD version to review this software.

The interface is simple, clean and very easy to understand. The top part of the window shows the hard drive as a rectangular diagram, and the partitions are drawn with proportional sizes. The file system, capacity, and free space of each partition are shown at the bottom.

You can right-click on a partition and resize, move, copy, format, or create a partition. After you perform a certain list of actions, a new pane pops at the bottom of the program, listing the actions and their sequence. This is just a preview of the actions, and you can review the actions and undo any or all actions. Once you feel that all is OK, you can click the Apply button to execute the actions. From this point on, you cannot undo anything.

GParted supports a host of file systems such as ext, ext2, FAT16, FAT32, NTFS, HFS, HFS+, and the list is seemingly endless. This software will give a run for their money to commercial Windows-based partition managers. We have only good things to say about it—full marks to GParted.

Specifications

Resize, move, copy, format, and create partitions, supports ext, ext2, FAT16, FAT32, NTFS, HFS, HFS+, JFS, Reiser4, ReiserFS, UFS, XFS, Linux Swap

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Web site: gparted.sourceforge.net
Price: Free